

Three Sides of Every Story

40 min · January Week 3

OBJECTIVE	Students practice perspective-taking by articulating three views of a conflict and explain how the compassionate observer perspective differs from both parties.
CASEL FOCUS	Social Awareness: perspective-taking · Relationship Skills: understanding conflict from multiple viewpoints
SCENARIO CARDS	Three Sides Cards A & B — friendship drift and teacher complaint scenarios
QUICK REVIEW	1-2 min: "Last lesson: impact vs. intent — which one does repair address? (student answers: impact) Today we go one step further: what happens when two people are both telling the truth about the same conflict, and both of their stories are only partial?"

EQUITY ALERT — DELIVER EXPLICITLY. NOT OPTIONAL.

Deliver this before worksheet work — not after: "Perspective-taking across cultural lines requires acknowledging that positions in a conflict are not always symmetric." "Seeing someone's perspective is not agreeing with what they did. You can fully understand someone's side and still be clear that what they did was wrong." "Understanding a perspective is not endorsing it."

ANCHOR CHART · THREE SIDES OF EVERY STORY — TRIANGLE DIAGRAM

Draw this triangle **before class**. Keep posted through L3. **POINT 1:** Your side — what you experienced, felt, needed. **POINT 2:** Their side — what they experienced, felt, needed. **POINT 3:** The Compassionate Observer — someone who cares about both people and sees what neither can from where they stand. Label the centre: "**The third side is the hardest — and the most important.**"

OPENING · 2 MINUTES

"Is it possible for two people to have a conflict, both be telling the truth, and both be telling a story that is only partial? Today we look at what happens when we step outside our own perspective — not to excuse the other person, but to understand more fully."